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UAE aid ship Khalifa departs for Gaza

LOADED WITH URGENT RELIEF SUPPLIES, SHIP FORMS PART OF ONGOING AID FOR PALESTINIANS

ABU DHABI

The eighth UAE aid ship, Khalifa, part of Operation Chivalrous Knight 3, departed yesterday from Khalifa Port in Abu Dhabi, heading to El Arish Port in Egypt. Loaded with urgent relief supplies, the ship forms part of the UAE's ongoing humanitarian support for the Palestinian people in the Gaza Strip. Khalifa is the largest aid vessel dispatched by the UAE to date, carrying 7,166 tonnes of essential food, medical and relief supplies. The cargo comprises 4,372 tonnes of food items, 1,433 tonnes of shelter materials, 860 tonnes of medical supplies and 501 tonnes of health supplies. This latest shipment brings the total volume of aid sent by the UAE to the Gaza Strip to 77,266 tonnes.

Humanitarian efforts

The initiative is part of a series of humanitarian efforts launched under Operation Chivalrous Knight 3, underscoring the UAE's steadfast commitment to providing support to those affected and in need, in cooperation with its charitable and humanitarian institutions. Meanwhile, the World Food Programme (WFP) said that Gaza's hunger crisis has "reached new levels of despera-



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tion," with people dying during humanitarian assistance. It warned that nearly one person in three is not eating for days. In a press release on Sunday, the WFP said that malnutrition is surging with 90,000 women and children in urgent need of treatment. The agency expressed deep

concern over the Israeli army's assault on civilians waiting for aid on Sunday, which resulted in the loss of countless lives. Many more suffered life-threatening injuries. These people were simply trying to access food to feed themselves and their families on the brink of starvation. "Today's violent incident

comes despite assurances from Israeli authorities that humanitarian operational conditions would improve; including that armed forces will not be present nor engage at any stage along humanitarian convoy routes," the WFP stressed. It added, "We stand firmly by our principles of operating with

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Watch: UAE aid ship Khalifa begins journey

independence, impartiality and neutrality. It is one of the many reasons why communities trust us." The agency stressed that only a massive scale-up in food aid distributions can stabilise this spiralling situation, calm anxieties and rebuild the trust within communities that more food is coming. It also called for an immediate ceasefire and guaranteed safe, regular, and systematic access for humanitarian aid across all parts of Gaza. "We urgently call on the international community and all parties to advocate for, and facilitate, the delivery of life-saving food aid to starving populations inside Gaza — safely, securely, wherever families are, and without obstruction," the WFP stressed. — WAM

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Bangladesh Air Force jet crash kills 20

DHAKA

A Bangladeshi fighter jet crashed into a school in the capital Dhaka yesterday, killing at least 20 people and injuring more than 170 in the country's deadliest aviation accident in decades. Many of the victims were young students who had just been let out of class when a Chinese-made F-7 BJI aircraft slammed into the Milestone School and College. An AFP photographer at the scene saw fire and rescue officials taking away the injured students on stretchers, while army personnel helped clear the mangled wreckage. A military statement said 20 people were killed, including the pilot, and 171 others injured when the jet crashed following a mechanical failure. The military said the pilot was on a routine training mission, when the jet "reportedly encountered a mechanical failure". — AFP

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UAE warns against AI apps: Protect your biometric data

Public urged to protect digital identity as face-editing apps surge in popularity

DUBAI

BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

The Abu Dhabi Department of Government Enablement has warned against the use of artificial intelligence apps that transform personal photos into cartoon-like images or digital avatars, cautioning that such seemingly harmless entertainment may be compromising users' biometric data. In a public awareness video posted on its official X account, the department highlighted the hidden risks of uploading personal facial images to AI-powered platforms.

Video warning

"With a single shot, AI can learn every facial detail," the video warned, adding that once this biometric data is captured, it can be ex-



ploited to create fake accounts, carry out fraud, or even generate deepfake videos. The department stressed that when users submit photos to AI editing tools, they are inadvertently sharing their unique biometric identity, making themselves vulnerable to misuse.

Protect privacy

Citizens and residents are urged to protect their privacy by deleting unnecessary applications, erasing uploaded photos from AI platforms, minimising app permissions, and fully restricting access to sensitive data.

The department also encouraged raising awareness among family and friends to collectively reduce the threat of biometric exploitation.



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